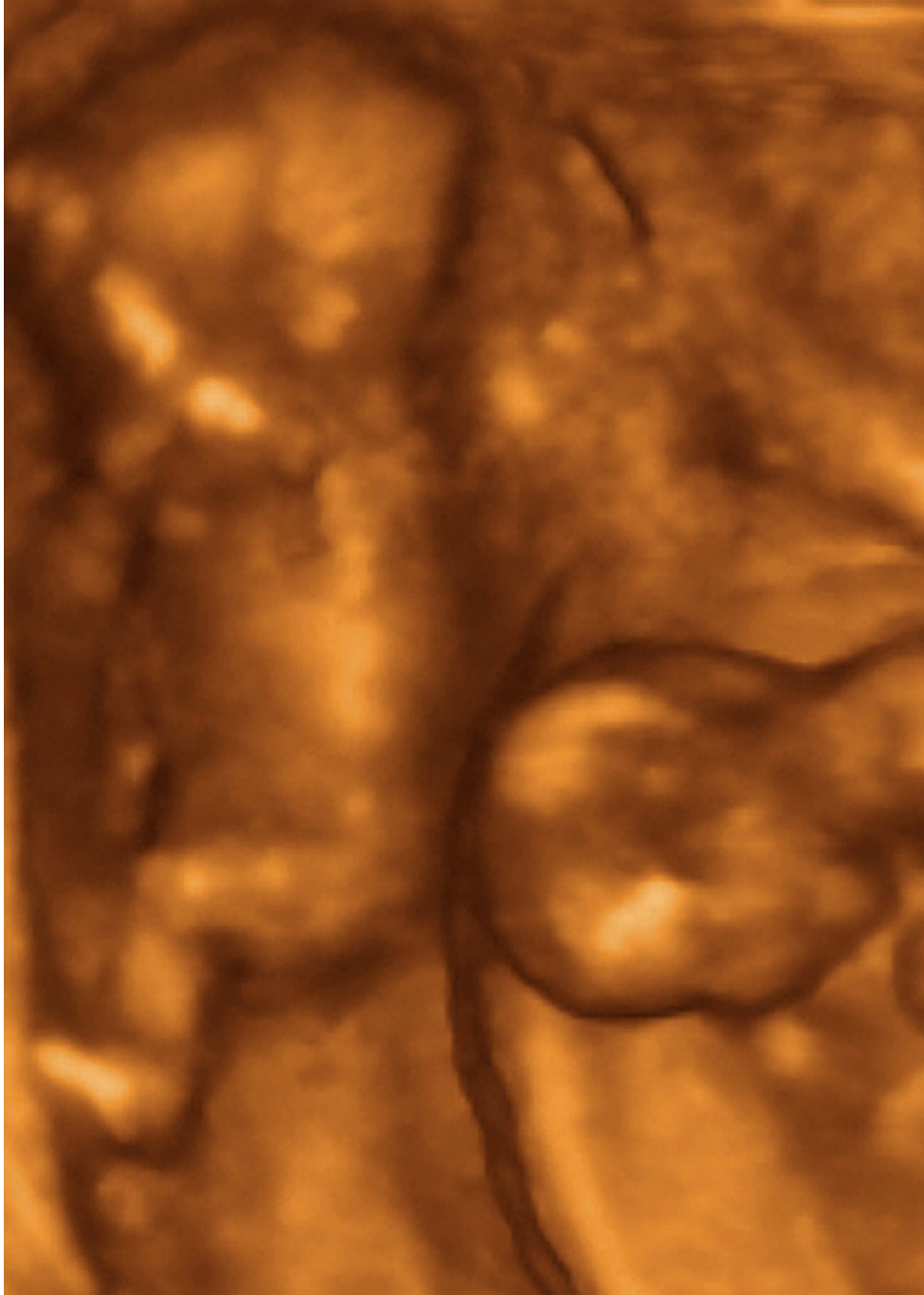




ASK A DOCTOR

Am I at increased risk of DVT when I fly? Deep vein thrombosis (DVT) is a condition in which a blood clot forms in a deep leg vein. It blocks the blood flow in the vein, causing pain and discomfort. The most serious complication of DVT is a pulmonary embolism, when part of the clot travels to the lungs, blocking a pulmonary artery. This can cause chest pain, shortness of breath, and blood-tinged phlegm to be coughed up. A pulmonary embolism can be fatal.

Pregnancy is considered to be a pro-thrombotic condition, meaning that clots are more likely to form in blood vessels. Pregnant women who have previously had DVT, who are aged 35 or over,